

3.2. Fundamentals of Academic Writing

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Code: SSMS-1S2-20

3.2.1. Introduction

The Academic Writing Course is designed to give students advanced tools in writing in English to aid them in their studies, research, and the workplace. The ability to write well in an academic and professional context is crucial to success in the SSMS field. Having a good oral proficiency in English does not guarantee being a good writer. The focus in this course will be on the fundamentals of academic and professional writing: how to structure paragraphs, how to create cohesion and coherence in a text, how to structure concise sentences, and how to produce a formal and professional style of writing. There will also be a focus on how to paraphrase. Attention will be given to punctuation, verb tense, and other aspects of grammar, but students will be expected to polish these areas in self-study with resources provided in a toolbox on Brightspace. Academic Writing is far more than just having good grammar or knowing where to place a comma.

3.2.2. Learning goals

- 1) The student can write academic text consisting of paragraphs with topic sentences and develop ideas using techniques of cohesion and coherence.
- 2) The student can produce academic sentences of suitable length, structure, and grammatical accuracy.
- 3) The student can produce text in the appropriate (formal) academic style of writing.
- 4) The student can identify the key points in a written text.
- 5) The student can paraphrase.

3.2.3. Literature

There is no required literature to be purchased. All readings and exercises will be provided on Brightspace by the lecturer.

3.2.4. Examination

Examination	
Type of examination	Written Exam (in Remindo)
Material for examination	The final exam will be similar to the writing tasks assigned throughout the course.
Type of product	NA
Submission protocol	NA
Criteria	See Assessment Forms in appendix 2
Weighting	100 %
Assessment procedure	See Assessment Forms in appendix 2
Pass mark	A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
Deadlines and possibilities	Exam: Practice Exam: 15 October 2026 Final exam (100%): 14 December 2026 Re-sit: Refer to the schedule for the date, time and location of the first and second opportunity

3.2.5. Programme

Session	Subject and contents (lessons)	Format	Preparation
1	What is a paragraph? What is a topic sentence?	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
2	6 tips to writing good paragraphs	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information Assignment: Task 1
3	10 characteristics of a more formal, academic writing style	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
4	5 tips to writing good sentences	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
5	Practice Exam in Remindo	Practice exam in computer room on campus	See Brightspace for specific information Assignment: Task 2
6	Techniques for combining sentences	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information Assignment: Task 3
7	How to paraphrase	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
8	Common mistakes + Review	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
Exam			

3.2.6. Rules & Regulations

Class attendance is not mandatory but strongly recommended for students to complete the course successfully.

Furthermore:

- 1) Several written tasks will be assigned during the course. Writing is a skill that needs to be practiced. Feedback will be given on your writing in these tasks which will help you identify what you are doing well and what needs to be polished. These tasks are the same as the one in the exam at the end of the course which is worth 100% of the course grade. These tasks should be uploaded on Brightspace in a Word document or pdf.
- 2) Peer Feedback is an essential element in this course. For several of the written tasks, students will be allocated a partner to both give and receive feedback according to the rubric on this task.
- 3) Students are responsible for polishing their grammar (verb tenses, relative clauses, conditionals, punctuation, parallel structure, comma splices) in the 'course information' on Brightspace. Little to no time will be devoted to this during the lectures due to time constraints.